

INNOVATORS

A · P · I · I · T



ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB
OF APIIT

EXCLUSIVE
ENTREPRENEUR
INTERVIEWS!

A space entrepreneurial journeys,
lessons learned, and
transformative experiences—a
collection of ventures, stories,
milestones, and discoveries.



VOLUME 2 • DECEMBER 2024



WWW.APIIT_ECLUB.COM



WHO ARE WE

APIIT COLOMBO

THE ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB

OUR OBJECTIVES

To encourage in students a spirit of entrepreneurship and to teach them the value of creating companies and enterprises that have a MAJOR INFLUENCE on the development of nations and society. In addition, the club will provide a venue for aspiring business owners to present their ideas and abilities while adhering to the standards established by the APIIT.

WHAT WE DO

We strive to create a platform to push our students' entrepreneurial flair. We provide chances for student entrepreneurs to showcase their products through fairs and other avenues. In addition, we provide experience sharing sessions with renowned businessmen and entrepreneurs, social sessions, networking sessions, competitions, and the occasional CSR project.





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CHAIRMAN'S MESSAGE

Entrepreneurship is the cornerstone of progress and growth in any society. Through the indomitable will and unyielding determination of entrepreneurs like you, we witness groundbreaking ideas taking shape, empowering countless lives, and shaping a better future. Your relentless pursuit of excellence and willingness to embrace challenges have redefined the very fabric of the Sri Lankan economy.

Today, we gather to commemorate the relentless efforts of all those who have dared to dream, who have dared to embark on the uncertain path of entrepreneurship. The goal of the APIIT Entrepreneurship Club (Club) is to ignite the flames of inspiration in the hearts of budding entrepreneurs and encourage them to pursue their dreams with vigour and determination.

**Chairman | Asia Pacific Institute of
Information Technology**

Bandula Egodage



I extend my heartfelt gratitude to all the members of APIIT E-Club and the Patron, Mr Vihanga Jayasinghe, whose hard work has brought this vision to life. Special thanks to the team, all APIIT students, and partners who have supported us in this endeavour.

To all aspiring entrepreneurs, remember that the journey ahead may be arduous, but it is in the face of adversity that true entrepreneurs rise. Embrace change, embrace failure, and embrace the unwavering belief in your dreams. The Innovators Digest Magazine Launch is a testament to your potential, and I encourage you all to embark on this journey with unwavering determination.



PATRON'S MESSAGE

Entrepreneurship is not merely a pursuit of profits; it is a journey of passion, perseverance, and purpose. Every entrepreneur embodies the essence of entrepreneurship and shows commitment to forging new paths and challenging the status quo, which is nothing short of commendable.

Today, we also unveil our much-anticipated magazine, "The Innovators' Digest", the labour of love crafted to celebrate the remarkable journeys of entrepreneurs who have left an indelible mark on their industries and communities. This magazine serves as a treasure trove of insights, experiences, and valuable lessons that will inspire the next generation of entrepreneurs to embrace challenges and seize opportunities. As the Club Patron, I extend my heartfelt appreciation to the team behind this magazine, whose dedication and passion have made this vision a reality.

Patron | Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT

Vihanga Jayasinghe

The stories shared within these pages will undoubtedly ignite the flames of creativity and determination in the hearts of aspiring entrepreneurs, encouraging them to overcome obstacles and reach for greatness. As we celebrate the launch of The Innovators' Digest Edition 02, let me reaffirm our commitment to fostering a culture of innovation, collaboration, and inclusivity. Together, we can create an ecosystem where entrepreneurial endeavors thrive and where individuals are empowered to unleash their potential and make a lasting impact on the world.





PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

As we close this chapter of the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo, I look back and see all the proud moments our club stood defiantly in its testament to furthering entrepreneurship and empowering our APIIT community. Reminiscing over the past year, our club has achieved great feats with diverse and exciting projects like Sandbox, Photopreneur, and Share the Story, and it is with so much pride we add this 2nd edition of Innovator's Digest to our growing list of vibrant initiatives.

The 2nd Edition of Innovator's Digest was no easy adventure - it is the culmination of a year of hard work by my amazing Magazine Team who have poured their dedication and creativity to make this magazine what it is and from being just a mere writer for the 1st Edition of Innovator's Digest to chairing its 2nd Edition, the fulfilment and pride instilled on me is immense.

President | Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT

Vidussh Gunasekera



Furthermore, taking over the mantle of President of the E-Club in December 2023 was not the easiest task, but it was a year of growth, opportunity and stepping out of my comfort zone - all things which I am so grateful for.

And finally an ode to my team. Sure, it wasn't the easiest year. But we made it and we did it! Our club now stands as one of the best in APIIT and we all worked hard to bring the E-Club to this position. I am incredibly proud of what we have all achieved and my sincerest wish is that this club continues to prosper!



VICE PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

When I first joined the Entrepreneurship Club, I was filled with uncertainty. Leadership was something I had always admired from a distance, but stepping into the position of Vice President gave me an entirely new perspective. It has been a transformative experience that has shaped me into a more confident, driven, and adaptable individual.

The challenges I faced while leading various initiatives taught me valuable lessons in responsibility, decision-making, and resilience. Working with such a talented team has shown me the power of collaboration and the importance of listening to different ideas. I've had the privilege of managing projects that push creative boundaries. More than anything, this role has empowered me to embrace challenges and grow beyond my limits.

Vice President | Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT

Amanya Ekanayake



It has made me realize that confidence is not something you're born with it's something you build. Entrepreneurship itself is an evolving journey, where every failure is a lesson and every success is a stepping stone. I've learned how to turn setbacks into learning experiences, how to communicate with people from various backgrounds, and how to manage time and expectations, both my own and others.

I'm incredibly proud of what we've accomplished together so far, but I'm even more excited about what's ahead I know it will inspire and challenge each and every one of you.



VICE PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

As the Vice President of the Entrepreneurship Club at APIIT, I have been working with passionate individuals to foster a culture of innovation and entrepreneurship. Our journey is not just about business, but also about building skills, cultivating resilience, and empowering students to take initiative.

Balancing academic responsibilities with leadership roles has taught me the value of time management, teamwork, and learning from failure. Entrepreneurship is not limited to starting businesses; it's a mindset that encourages problem-solving, creativity, and a proactive attitude.

I encourage aspiring entrepreneurs and innovators to step out of their comfort zone and get involved in the club.

Vice President | Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT

Kavindu Wannisinghe



At APIIT, we have a supportive environment that nurtures growth, and I invite each of you to make the most of these opportunities

The Entrepreneurship Club aims to create platforms for students to develop their skills and make meaningful connections, offering business pitching competitions and workshops with industry leaders.

In conclusion, success is not about the destination, but about the journey and the lessons learned along the way. Let's support each other, grow together, and make the most of this exciting chapter in our lives.



CLUB ACTIVITIES

WORKSHOPS



We conduct workshops for the benefit of our APIIT community to expand their skills and learn new things, not only about entrepreneurship but also about life.

EXPERIENCE SHARING SESSIONS



We bring in seasoned and renowned entrepreneurs in a variety of fields such as the founders of Barista Sri Lanka and Kapla motors to impart valuable knowledge to our students.

SANDBOX



Our signature project, Sandbox is an annual interschool Business Pitching Competition aimed at empowering entrepreneurship in the youth of our country for a better tomorrow.



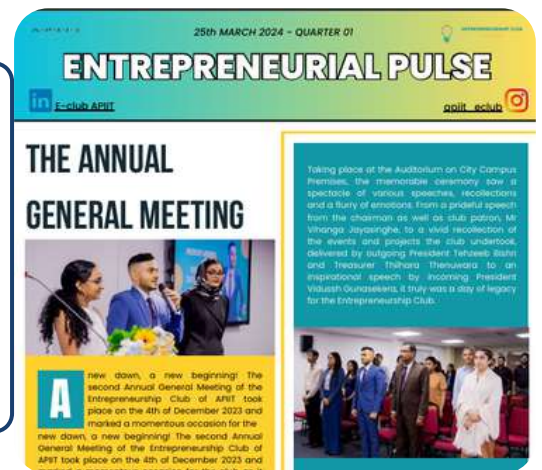
CSR PROJECTS

With the aim of giving back to the community, our club hosted multiple community initiatives not only for our APIIT community but also externally from book donation drives to mental health awareness.



NEWSLETTER

Published every month, Entrepreneurial Pulse, is our signature newsletter featuring interviews with student entrepreneurs, general articles on the business world and much more!



FAIRS

Striving to help our student entrepreneurs at campus, the E-Club hosts fairs for entrepreneurs to come and sell their products as campus premises to get their businesses out there.



CLUB ACTIVITIES



OUR MILESTONES

1



04th December 2024

Annual General Meeting and Appointment of the 2nd Executive Committee for the club.

2



22nd December 2024

Hosted our first official event as the 2nd EXCO - Musique De Noel 2.0, the Christmas Carols.

3



15th March 2024

Hosted our first ever women's day themed event and panel discussion.

9



28th June 2024

Crossed 500 followers on Instagram, marking a milestone for social media.

8



05th July 2024

Represented APIIT at the New Generation Youth Conference

10



10th September 2024

Began the first phase of our signature project, the Sandbox competition.

11



09th October 2024

Successfully and grandly concluded our main project, the Sandbox competition.

12



25th October 2024

Rolled out our first digital impact project - Project Off the Script.



4



26th March 2024

Launched the 1st ever issue of Entrepreneurial Pulse, the E-Club monthly magazine.

5



24th April 2024

Rolled out BizQuiz Biweekly as a new monthly club initiative for students.

7



04th September 2024

Conducted our first ever external community project with the Kandy E-Club.

6



06th September 2024

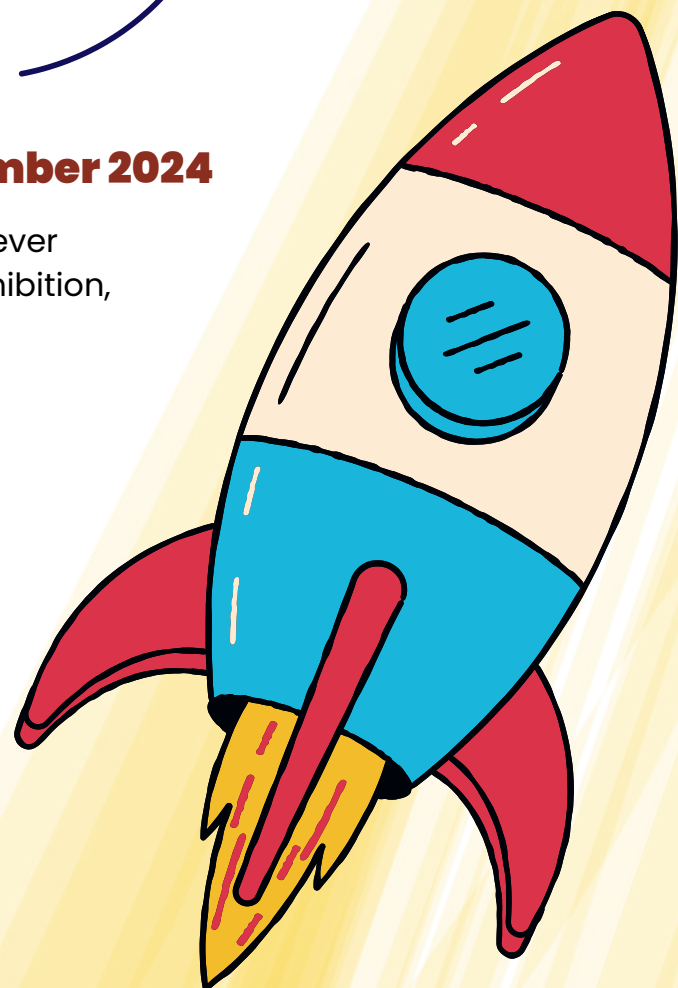
Hosted our first ever Photography Exhibition, Photopreneur.

13



19th November 2024

Celebrated Global Entrepreneurship Week and held Project Pitch Perfect.

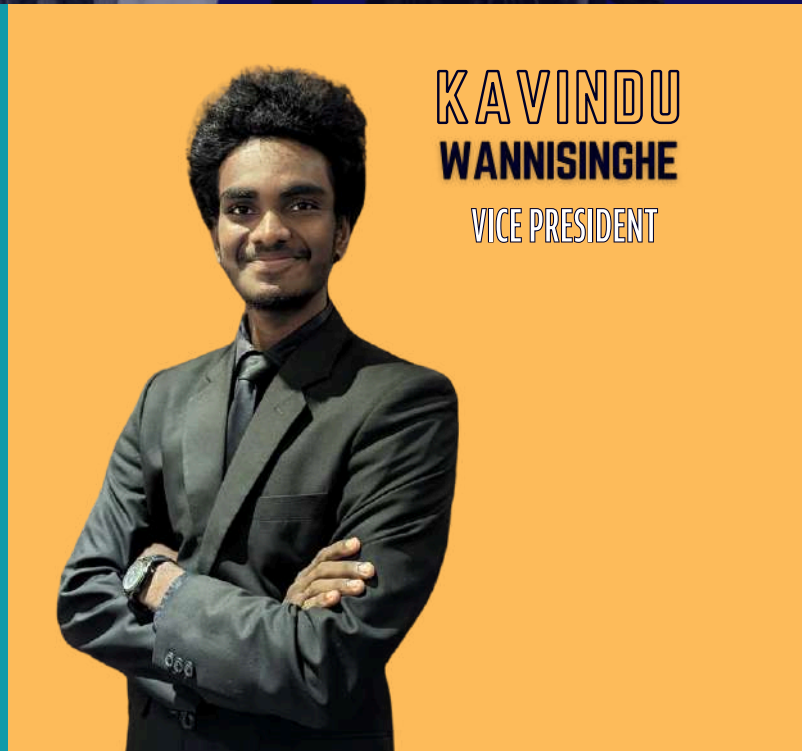




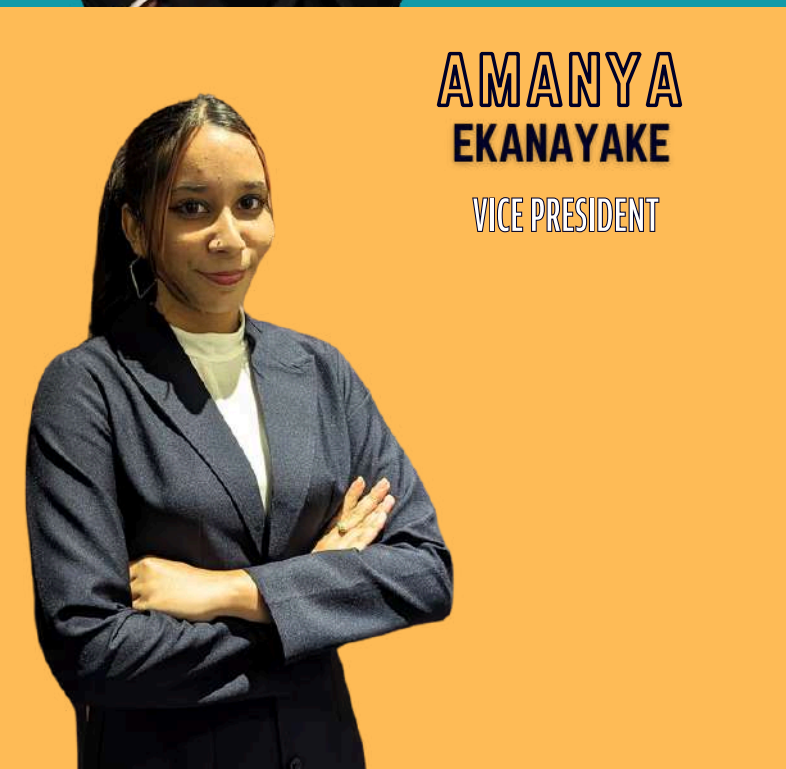
Meet the EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE



**VIDUSSH
GUNASEKERA**
PRESIDENT



**KAVINDU
WANNISINGHE**
VICE PRESIDENT



**AMANYA
EKANAYAKE**
VICE PRESIDENT



**DEWDUN
JAYAKODY**
SECRETARY



HIMIDIRI
PARANAYAPA

TREASURER



HIRA
ISMATH

ASST. TREASURER



DINELI
JAYASINGHE

EVENTS LEAD



MADHUMITHA
BALAJEYANDHAN

EVENTS LEAD



Introducing
**THE BRAINS
OF THE CLUB**

KESHINY
SRITHARAN

MEDIA LEAD



THANUSHRI
WIJENDRAN

MEDIA LEAD



SHERAYA
SAMARANAYAKE

MARKETING LEAD



SHARTHVIKAA
ANANTHKUMAR

MARKETING LEAD





OUR EVENTS





TRANSITION MEETING

“

PASSING THE TORCH FOR THE NEXT
COMMITTEE TO CONTINUE THE LEGACY AS
THE NEXT GENERATION OF THE
ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB

”

The transition meeting for the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo took place on the 19th of November 2023 with the incoming Executive Committee and the Outgoing Executive President and Treasurer in attendance along with the club patron. Setting a casual tone, the transition meeting was held at a cozy Barista close to the APIIT City Campus and marked the official beginning of the tenure of the Executive Committee for the years 2023/2024.



The meeting saw the official transfer of power from the past president and was a good opportunity for the new team, which encompassed a diverse mixture of business, law and computing students, to get to know each other and build the team spirit. The Transition Meeting also saw the patron of the club, Mr. Vihanga Jayasinghe, address the new team for the first time.

ANNUAL

MEETING OF

&

Where the journey began, and the transformation took root



ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB
OF APIIT

INNOVATORS DIGEST

Lighting the oil lamp by Club patron, former president and incoming president



GENERAL

THE E-CLUB



Built on a stance of diversity, creativity and innovation



ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB
OF APIIT

INNOVATORS DIGEST

Introducing the brand new team of the E-Club for
the 2023/2024 tenure commencing.



A NEW DAWN



A new dawn, a new beginning! The second Annual General Meeting of the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT took place on the 4th of December 2023 and marked a momentous occasion for the taking place at the Auditorium on City Campus Premises, the memorable ceremony saw a spectacle of various speeches, recollections and a flurry of emotions. From a prideful speech from the chairman as well as club patron, Mr Vihanga Jayasinghe, to a vivid recollection of the events and projects the club undertook, delivered by outgoing President Tehzeeb Bishri and Treasurer Thilhara Thenuwara to an inspirational speech by incoming President Vidussh Gunasekera, it truly was a day of legacy or the Entrepreneurship Club.

The Annual General Meeting commenced with the signatory lighting of the oil lamp, a testament to our proud culture, with various esteemed individuals gracing the occasion

from the chairman of APIIT Sri Lanka, Mr Bandula Egodage, Head of APIIT Business School, Doctor Hasuli Perera, Head of APIIT Law School, Dr Chathura Warnasuriya, Head of APIIT Computing School, Mr Gamindu and all club patrons. New dawn, a new beginning!

Taking place at the Auditorium on City Campus Premises, the memorable ceremony saw a spectacle of various speeches, recollections and a flurry of emotions.



Together, we're ready to take on the year ahead!



From a prideful speech from the chairman as well as club patron, Mr Vihanga Jayasinghe, to a vivid recollection of the events and projects the club undertook, delivered by outgoing President Tehzeeb Bishri and Treasurer Thilhara Thenuwara to an inspirational speech by incoming President Vidussh Gunasekera, it truly was a day of legacy for the Entrepreneurship Club.

As with all joyous occasions, the second Annual General Meeting concluded with the badging ceremony of the current committee as well as a farewell to the outgoing committee followed by refreshments and happy interactions. As the E-Club now embarks on another year of momentous and triumphant projects, we welcome all E-Club members to actively engage and interact to be groomed as future leaders!

MUSIQUE DE NOEL

2023



A JOINT PROJECT BY ROTARACT, MDMMS, ECLUB,
RESOLVERS AND SAC

MELODIES OF THE SEASON: RELIVING THE MAGIC OF CHRISTMAS CAROLS

The Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT in collaboration with the Rotaract Club of APIIT; Resolvers, the MDMMS club of APIIT Colombo and the Student Activity Club of Colombo Campus organized the Christmas Carols of 2023 under the banner of Musique De Noel 2.0. Signifying as the first project of the 2023/2024 tenure of the new committee of the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT, Musique De Noel 2.0 also served as the club's first community project, aimed at bringing the Christmas spirit to APIIT hallways and the rest of the campus.

Taking place on the 22nd of December 2023 at the Auditorium in City Campus, Musique De Noel 2.0 the clubs banding together to spread the Christmas joy among the APIIT student body. With a massive participation by APIITians and Staff alike, Musique De Noel was surely an event to remember, basking in the glory of December's holiness and eventfulness. Decorated by bright lights and elegant Christmas Decor, Musique De Noel sets centerstage as unique collaboration and interdependence between APIIT Clubs.



A WOMEN'S DAY INITIATIVE

Project HER STORY



ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB
OF APIIT

INNOVATORS DIGEST

INNOVATOR'S DIGEST





WOMEN, SHAPING THE FUTURE

"Behind every great woman... is another great woman"
~ Kate Hodges

IN COMMEMORATION OF INTERNATIONAL WOMEN'S DAY

The Entrepreneurship Club held Project HerStory, a project aimed at celebrating and empowering all the women in our lives. Chaired by Vice President Amanyaa Ekanayake and Events Lead Madhumitha Balajayendhan, Project HerStory took place on the 15th of March 2024 at the School of Foundation; APIIT's newest facility. Coincidentally, the Entrepreneurship Club was the first club at APIIT to host an event at the new facility. The main guests of honour for the event were Ms. Shiranaaz Kaney, Chief Operating Office of Clootrack Software Labs and Ms. Yanika Amarasekera, Founder and Chief Operating Officer of Silver Aisle.

Following experience sharing and inspirational addresses from both Chief Guests, the event moved to its signature piece- a panel discussion titled "Girls in Power : APIIT Club Edition" where representatives from some of the major APIIT Clubs were present.

The panelists were Ms. Shiranaaz Kaney, Ms. Yanika Amarasekera, Ms. Vithara Mannage (Lecturer), Amanyaa Ekanayaka (E-Club Vice President), Sharthvikaa Ananthkumar (Vice President, Social - SAC), Samaa Shazuli (Editor in Chief of The Catalyst), Suhayla Ralick (Editor of Rotaract) and Runeesha Senadeera (Events Manager of FCS).





InnovateX





TO align with one of the key themes assigned by the Entrepreneurship Club for the year 2024, Creativity and Innovation, the initiative was undertaken to organize an experience sharing session and workshop that would enable students to understand the importance of embracing creativity and innovation as entrepreneurs and in the corporate world. The key entrepreneur for the project was famed national swimmer and entrepreneur Mr. Cherantha De Silva.

The resource person, Mr Cherantha De Silva is a world championship swimmer currently working on a mineral technological startup that can help boost the Sri Lankan economy. He firmly believes the value addition of Sri Lankan minerals has to take place here on home soil and not elsewhere and his professional growth encompasses roles with an Executive Director role of Kapla Motor Industries in Colombo and as an Analyst at Langar Holdings in San Diego.

Innovate X, which was chaired by President Vidussh Gunasekera, took place on the 20th of March 2024 at the School of Foundation, Access Towers II from 4PM onwards with Mr. Cherantha De Silva taking attendees through his journey of being a young entrepreneur with tips on tackling obstacles faced in the Sri Lankan business environment, especially by young entrepreneurs. The token of appreciation was handed over by Doctor Hasuli Perera.

Innovate X





Art of NEGOTIATION

In this current day and age where business operations have become more increasingly volatile and dynamic, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT in partnership with MDMMS of APIIT Colombo organized a workshop focusing on the Art of Negotiation, a project which would focus on the role negotiation plays in the current world and why it is an important competency to possess.



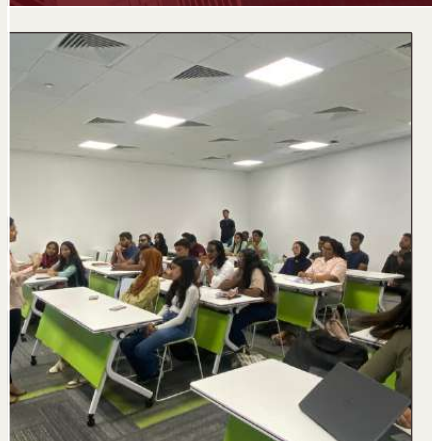
Ms. Saranee Gunathilaka, an Attorney-At-Law, accredited Mediator (SIMI/IMI/IICA) and Master Negotiator from Harvard was the resource person for the Art of Negotiation. The workshop took place on the 26th of April 2024 at the School of Foundation, Access Towers II from 9.30AM to 11.30AM. The session focused on the benefits of effective negotiation, common negotiation scenarios for entrepreneurs, setting negotiation goals and clear objectives, communication strategies and crafting clear and compelling arguments. It also highlighted the first ever interclub collaboration between the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT and Moot, Mock and Debating Society of APIIT Colombo, setting the foundation for the future collaborations between the two clubs with the project being chaired by President Vidussh Gunasekera and Head of Media Keshiny Sritharan.



THE ART OF NEGOTIATION



ELEVATING YOUR NEGOTIATION SKILLS TO NEW HEIGHTS



CREATOR'S CORNER

THERAPY WITH *Painting*

AS the assignment season looms upon our student body, stress and tension will run high across campus with exhaustion, and even depression. With that initiative in mind, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo decided that it was the best time to engage in a Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) project to give back to the very society gives us life.

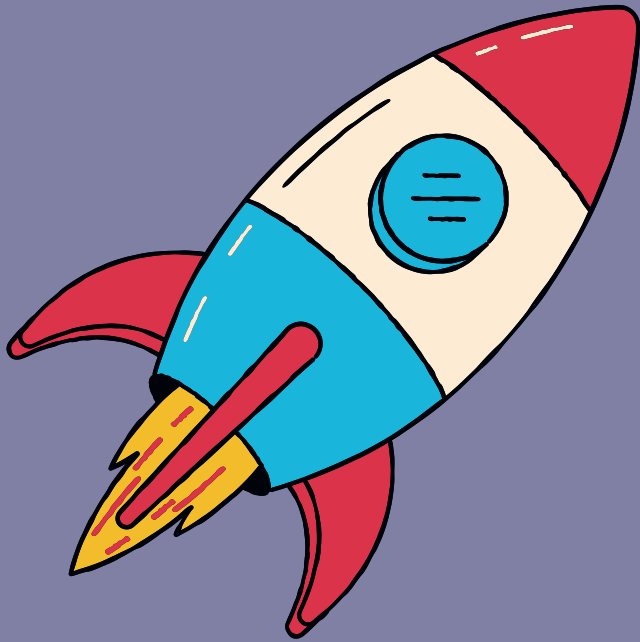


Creator's Corner was an opportunity for students to express their frustrations and stress over assignments through painting. Under one of the club's themes for the year 2024, Creativity and Innovation, this project aimed to create a platform for creative expression.

The session focused on how our students would paint their emotions away on the blank canvas and to see what artistic wonders it would result in. Completely free-of-charge for everyone, the Entrepreneurship Club provided canvases, paint, paint brushes and other necessary equipment for our students to have loads of fun and express their frustrations. Chaired by Events Lead Dineli Jayasinghe and President Vidussh Gunasekera, this project saw not only students but also lecturers engaging and putting their minds off the stressful times hovering around.



At the conclusion of the workshop, a small vote was conducted for the best painting following which two magnificent works of art were shortlisted. The lucky winner was Suhayla Ralick, a second-year Business Innovation Student and the winning prize, a voucher from Butter Boutique to satisfy your sweet cravings, was handed over to her by patron, Mr Vihanga Jayasinghe. With an overwhelming response, we hope to return with Creator's Corner soon!



SUMMER WITH APIIT

AS

the primary project for June, the EClub had the pleasure of hosting our fellow students from Staffordshire University on a unique educational excursion! As part of the Summer with APIIT exchange program, 26 students explored Sri Lanka's vibrant culture and educational landscape. Our club took the initiative, guiding them through the captivating halls of the Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art (MMCA) located in the heart of Colombo 03.

This architectural gem offered a glimpse into Sri Lanka's post-colonial architectural niche, sparking curiosity and discussion on yet another aspect of Sri Lanka. The MMCA experience wasn't just about the physical space. We arranged a special movie screening that delved deeper into the artistic narratives showcased within the museum's walls. While the artistic styles might not have resonated with everyone, the overall experience proved to be a valuable one, fostering open discussions and a broader appreciation for the artistry.



The Club was represented by President Vidussh Gunasekera, Vice Presidents Amanyanka Ekanayake and Kavindu Wannisinghe, Secretary Dewdun Jayakody, Treasurer Himidiri Wickramabahu, and Events Lead Madhumitha Balajeyandhan. We at the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo believe that exposure to diverse perspectives and experiences is a very crucial aspect of personal and professional growth no matter what dynamic field you hail from as there is always opportunity to learn and grow. This exchange program served as a testament to that belief, and we're thrilled to have played a part in enriching the Sri Lankan experience for our Staffordshire counterparts!





AS

this month's primary project, FoodFest provided a platform for aspiring student entrepreneurs to showcase their culinary creations and business ideas to a vibrant audience. With a diverse range of stalls, including Nail Express by Shery, TeaLicious, Asteria, The Ocakes, the Rotaract Club of APIIT, and the Conservatory Club of APIIT attendees were treated to a delicious and delightful experience. Under our vision of inspiring entrepreneurship among the massive student body of APIIT, as well as bringing in sales for our young entrepreneurs along with publicity and market access, FoodFest, being the first fair by the 2023/2024 board of the Entrepreneurship Club, aimed to provide publicity and also served as a launchpad



-d for our budding entrepreneurs, providing valuable experience in product presentation, customer interaction, and navigating a real-world market environment and also served as the first fair for the current year. The event drew a massive crowd, transforming the L5 outdoor area in City Campus into a bustling marketplace from 12PM onwards. Attendees enjoyed delicious food, fun music, and exciting games, creating a vibrant and enjoyable atmosphere.

We would also like to extend a special congratulations to our very own Sheraya Samaranayake, owner of Nail Express by Sherry, for winning the coveted Rs. 10,000 cash prize! Chaired by Vice President Amany Ekanayake, FoodFest truly helped in cultivating the spirit of entrepreneurship under the banner of Entrepreneurial Skills, which is the basis of our club's existence here at APIIT thus helping us hit a significant milestone.

The APIIT Entrepreneurship Club is grateful to all the talented vendors who participated, showcasing their passion and dedication. A sincere thank you to everyone who attended and supported this phenomenal event. FoodFest stands as a testament to the thriving spirit of innovation and entrepreneurship within the APIIT community. We look forward to hosting more fairs that empower and inspire our student entrepreneurs to have successful ventures!





Stirring the Perfect Blend of Coffee and Entrepreneurship



The Club proudly hosted resounding success – Coffee Chats, a dynamic session featuring Mr. Dilupa Pathirana, the CEO of Barista Sri Lanka. Held on the 17th of July, 2024 at the Auditorium in City Campus premises, the event drew a vibrant and eager crowd of aspiring students and potential future entrepreneurs hungry for knowledge and inspiration. Mr. Pathirana's insightful presentation delved into the secrets of building a successful brand in the Sri Lankan cafe industry.

Coffee Chats wasn't just about the speaker. It fostered a vibrant community atmosphere. The event space buzzed with conversation as students connected, exchanged ideas, and built valuable networks. The APIIT Entrepreneurship Club provided an environment where aspiring entrepreneurs felt empowered and supported – a crucial element for their future success.

BREWING SUCCESS



THE OVERWHELMING POSITIVE RESPONSE

to Coffee Chats is a testament to the thriving spirit of innovation and entrepreneurship within the APIIT community. The Entrepreneurship Club Of APIIT Colombo extends its gratitude to Mr. Dilupa Pathirana for sharing his expertise and to all the attendees for their enthusiastic participation. Coffee Chats served as a launchpad for future events, and the club is committed to providing students with the resources and inspiration they need to turn their ambitious dreams into reality.



Chaired by President Vidussh Gunasekera and Head of Media Keshiny Sritharan, Coffee Chats was truly a one of a kind event. With a future series of events themed around Coffee Chats imminent, we look forward to hosting more creative and successful events featuring insightful entrepreneurs.





Unleash Your Best U!

ON the 1st of August 2024, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT, in collaboration with Unilever and the Unilever Sparks program, hosted a highly insightful session titled Unleash Your Best U. This event aimed to equip young undergraduates with key knowledge on corporate etiquette and personal branding which are essential elements for thriving in today's competitive, fast growing and high



ly professional landscape. The session was led by Mr. Shamil Akbar, Internal Communications Manager and Executive Assistant to the CEO of Unilever Sri Lanka, and saw a strong turnout of enthusiastic students. The event, chaired by E-Club Head of Marketing and Unilever Spark, Sheraya Samaranayake, was a resounding success.



Held at City Campus L5 CR4 from 8:45 to 10:30 AM, it attracted a large audience eager to learn how to craft their professional identities and align their personal values with their career aspirations. In his talk, Mr. Akbar highlighted how personal branding is more than just a buzzword; it is a strategic tool that can significantly influence career growth. In today's corporate world, having a unique and authentic brand can set individuals apart from the competition, open doors to new opportunities, and establish a professional presence that resonates with employers and industry leaders alike.



By focusing on these areas, young graduates can shape their personal and professional journeys to reflect both who they are and who they aspire to become. Unleash Your Best U provided a platform for students to rethink their approach to career growth and self-presentation. The lessons imparted by Mr. Akbar will undoubtedly resonate with attendees as they step into the world of work, equipped with the skills and mindset necessary to succeed in today's dynamic business environment.



FinLit

WITH  *CAL*

Empowering Futures: Financial Literacy and Investing Workshop

Proper financial planning isn't just about saving or investing—it's about setting financial goals, creating budgets, managing debt, and making informed decisions that align with one's lifestyle and aspirations. The CAL experts discussed how good financial habits can lead to greater financial freedom, reduced stress, and the ability to pursue personal and professional ambitions without the burden of financial uncertainty.



Moreover, the importance of setting clear financial goals and having a structured plan was emphasized as key to achieving financial success. FinLit with CAL provided attendees with not just the knowledge but the motivation to start thinking seriously about their financial futures. By understanding the principles of smart investing and effective financial planning, young undergraduates can take their first steps toward securing financial independence and stability.

BUILDING FINANCIAL CONFIDENCE





SHARE THE GIFT OF KNOWLEDGE, ONE BOOK AT A TIME

Share the Story!

A BOOK DONATION DRIVE

Successfully concluded on the
4th of September

Location:
Kandy, Sri Lanka

Combined initiative by the
eclubs of Kandy and
Colombo



project Share the Story successfully concluded on the 04th of September 2024 with a resounding impact. The project which took place in two phases, was the first community project of the Entrepreneurship club of APIIT Colombo Campus. In collaboration with the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Kandy Campus, the aim of the project was to build a library for a rural school in Kandy. The first phase of the project saw both clubs running a book donation campaign in their respective campuses with the EClub of APIIT Colombo collecting over a 100 books.

Share the Story is one of the most unique projects undertaken by the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo in collaboration with the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Kandy Campus. Being a community project, this project saw the two clubs embarking on a drive to collect a variety of books for donation from story books to atlases to non-fiction fact books with nearly a collection of 100 books by the donation deadline of August 23rd. The donation point was the City Campus Library for Colombo.



The clubs collected Children's, Educational, Story and Non Fiction books in all three languages – English, Sinhala and Tamil over the course of the month of August.

Small Steps, Big Impact



Phase 02 – Kandy

"In the case of good books, the point is not to see how many you can get through, but how many can get through to you."
— Mortimer J. Adler

The **E-Club of the Colombo Campus** also pledged to provide stationery packs to the students of the school, calling in donations from the staff of Colombo campus as well. Following the conclusion of the 1st phase of the project, the 2nd phase saw the Colombo team travelling to Kandy via train on an exciting excursion. Participated by seven club EXCO members, four volunteers and three lecturers, the 2nd phase of the project took place on the 04th of September. Rendezvousing with the Kandy Eclub Team, the two teams then travelled to the school from the Kandy Railway Station to donate the books and stationery packs and to engage in a day of fun activities and enjoyment with the school students.



The school students engaged in a drawing sessions dubbed “draw your dreams” followed by snacks and more fun activities like musical chairs and dancing which the kids enjoyed. The project’s aim did not only revolve round building a library but also on making an impact on the lives of these children who were confined to the walls of the school. With immense gratitude the Entrepreneurship Club of Kandy, the project was successfully concluded with dreams achieved, impact created and memories made.



photopreneur

turning passion into
entrepreneurship





The Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT successfully concluded an exciting and visually captivating project dedicated to photography enthusiasts within the campus. Held under the banner of Photopreneur, the competition aimed to provide a platform for students to showcase their talent across four diverse themes: nature, history, architecture, and society. The project unfolded in two vibrant phases. In the first phase, participants were invited to submit their best photographs reflecting these excitin

g theme. The response was beyond expectations, with over 200 vibrant photographs submitted. The second phase culminated in a grand exhibition on the 6th of September 2024, hosted at APIIT's City Campus. From the 200 submissions, 60 cinematic and exceptional photographs were shortlisted for display, transforming the space into a gallery of creativity and storytelling. The exhibition was honored by the presence of Chief Guest Mr. Avi Suriyabandara, a famous and reputed photographer, whose presence added prestige to the event. Photopreneur stands as a testament to turning passions into business.



PART 01 - OPENING CEREMONY AND WORKSHOPS

The opening ceremony and workshop session of the signature project of the Entrepreneurship Club, Sandbox Inter-School Business Pitching, took place on the 10th of September 2024 at the auditorium, City Campus premises. Marking the official launch of the competition, the event commenced at 8.30AM, hosted by Methuli Perera where she took the participating schools through the structure of the competition, prizes, rules and regulations, the theme and the timeline. Participating schools included DS Senanayake College, St Bridget's Convent, Thurstan College, Bandranayake Central College Gampaha, St Nicholas International School and Gateway College Colombo.

The workshop session commenced at 9.15AM, conducted by Sasnaka Sansada, a government registered charitable organization aimed at brining welfare. The session was conducted by Ms Chamodi Swarnasinghe where she took the school teams along the process of constructing a viable business plan with the students being provided a specific template by the Sasnaka Sansada Foundation. Students were given the opportunity to ask questions and clarify their doubts about making a business plan and putting their business idea into words before the session wrapped up at 11AM for a break where a light refreshment was offered to participants.



The objective of this session was to provide the participating teams a unique and fair opportunity to further their skills and knowledge about the business world and also to make Sandbox a fair and transparent competition. The provision of this workshop also resonated with the Entrepreneurship Club's vision to spread awareness about entrepreneurship and its requisites among the next generation that will take the reigns and lead the country. The E-Club would like to thank everyone who participated and helped make the Sandbox Opening a success!





MOVIE NIGHT

BRINGING THE CINEMA MAGIC TO
OUR APIIT FAM! TAKE A BREAK AND
JOIN US FOR MOVIE NIGHT.

27th Sept | AT 4PM | L3CR8

FEAT. THE DELIEVERANCE

IN

line with the looming assignment season for the semester ending October, the Entrepreneurship Club decided to host a Movie Night to help students relieve some stress and take a break

from the academic stress caused by assignments. Falling under our Diversity and Inclusion pillar, this community project aimed to bring our APIIT community together to experience the magic of cinema and also the start of the spooky season.



With nearly 30 attendants, Movie Night took place at L3 CR8 at City Campus on the 27th of September 2024 at 4PM. To inaugurate the upcoming spooky season with Halloween falling in October, the club decided to showcase a horror movie - The Deliverance. The initiative truly brought our students together for an exciting and thrilling movie experience and provided a well deserved break for some of our APIIT family caught deep in their assignments and we look forward to more exciting community initiatives!

The Deliverance is a Netflix original supernatural horror film directed by Lee Daniels, inspired by a true story. The movie stars Andra Day as Ebony Jackson, a single mother battling personal and supernatural demons, alongside Glenn Close. The film explores themes of possession, faith, and resilience as Ebony fights to protect her family from malevolent forces threatening to tear them apart. Released on Netflix on August 30, 2024, it blends suspense and drama in a genre-defying narrative.



SANDBOX

PART 02 - GRAND FINALE OF THE COMPETITION

The Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT hosted the grand finale of its signature event, the Sandbox InterSchool Business Pitching Competition, at the Lotus Hall, BMICH, on the 9th of October 2024. With strong participation from schools across Colombo and beyond, the event was a major success, aiming to inspire young minds and promote the spirit of entrepreneurship. In the fin

al round, participants presented their business plans and delivered a 5-minute pitch, followed by a 5-minute Q&A session with a panel of judges. The pitches were the highlight of the event, with teams confidently sharing their vision for a sustainable future. They addressed crucial aspects of their ideas, from the problem they were tackling to their proposed solutions, target markets, and revenue models.





The panel, composed of experienced industry professionals such as Mr. Nuwan Pathirana (Sampath Bank), Ms. Nathasha Egodage (Ceyline Group), Mr. Hasitha Wijesundara (Consultant and Economist), Ms. Achala Samaradiwakara (Good Market), and Ms. Shyamani Periyapperumma (Central Environment Authority), provided insightful feedback during the Q&A sessions, focusing on topics like market positioning, scalability, and financial viability.

The competition culminated in an exciting awards ceremony, where five awards were presented to the top-performing teams. Gateway College Colombo stood out, winning both the Best Business Idea and Most Sustainable Solution awards, while DS Senanayake College and St. Bridget's Convent secured the 2nd and 3rd places respectively. The Most Popular Business Idea, determined by an audience vote, was awarded to Royal College Colombo. The winning teams accepted their awards and the coveted Sandbox Shield with pride, marking a memorable conclusion to the event.





SANDBOX

THE JOURNEY IN PICTURES

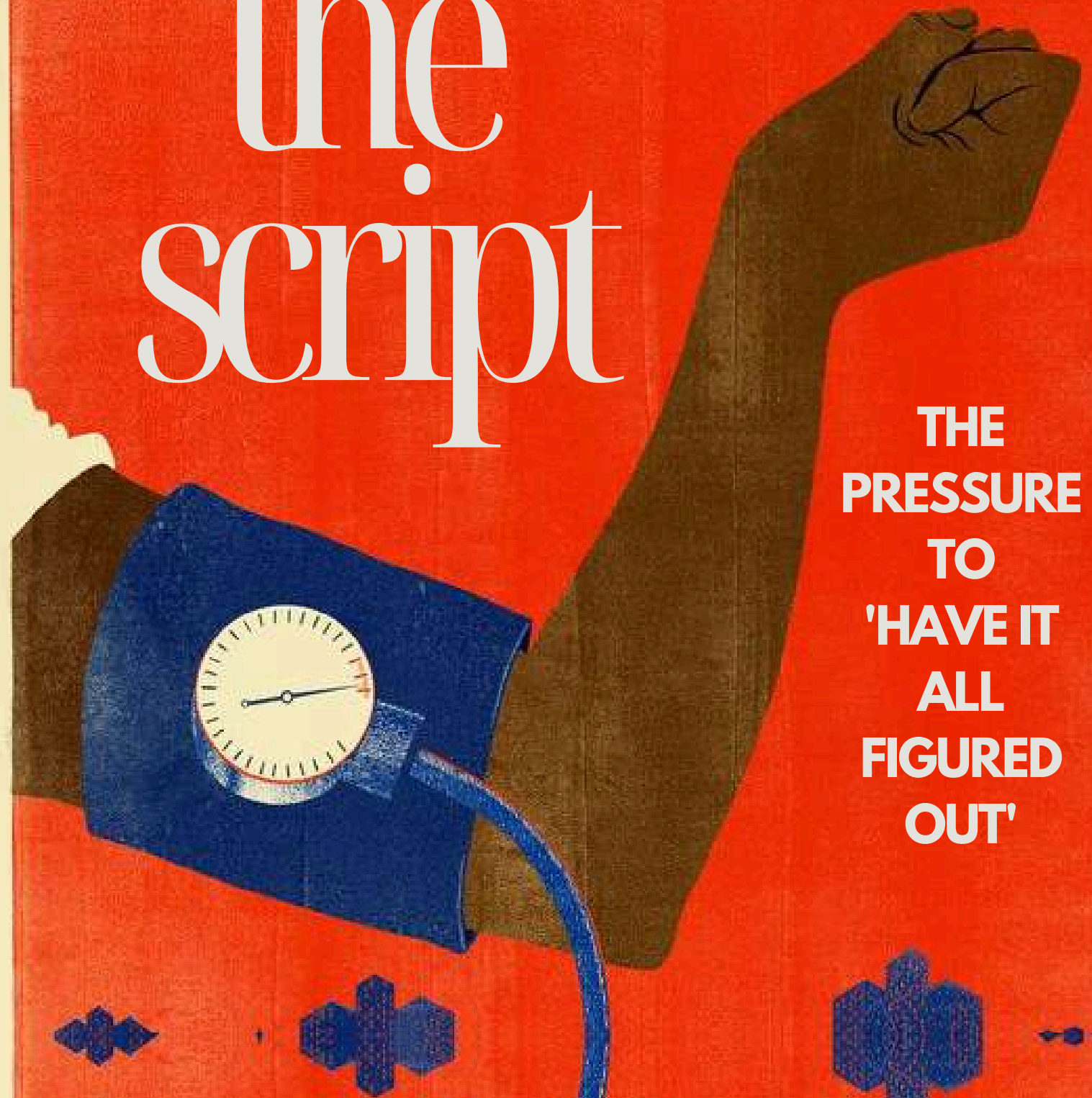






off the script

**THE
PRESSURE
TO
'HAVE IT
ALL
FIGURED
OUT'**





Many successful figures, like Walt Disney, started in unexpected roles, proving that setbacks and experimenting are key to discovering your path.

Social issues have become an increasingly aggravating issue in the world, especially among the youth and more specifically in university students. Over the years, a rise has been observed in several issues pertaining to undergraduate students such as depression, bullying in various forms, career uncertainty, mental health decline and much more.



Capitalizing on this rising need to raise awareness for this vital issues, the E-Club took the initiative to embark on a digital initiative to raise awareness for a crucial issue with the target audience being APIIT students and university students as a whole. Dubbed "Off the Script" this digital initiative, chaired by Head of Media, Thanushri Wijendran, saw the implementation of a digital campaign aimed at raising awareness about "the pressure to have it all figured out".

The project saw the club utilizing social media as its key platform and rolling out multiple Instagram and LinkedIn posts as part of the campaign bringing students a plethora of information from statistics about mental health to stories from the community to how students can overcome the pressure to have it all figured out. Being a one of a kind project, Off the Script, plays a huge role in community initiatives for the club.





GLOBAL
ENTREPRENEURSHIP
WEEK
OFFICIAL ACTIVITY



ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB
OF APIIT

INNOVATORS DIGEST

PITCH PERFECT



celebration of the Global Entrepreneurship Week for 2024, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT proudly hosted Pitch Perfect — a workshop designed to bridge the gap between aspiring entrepreneurs and industry experts in the realm of marketing. Held on the 19th of November at the ICTA Sri Lanka SPARX Lab from 9AM onwards, this event was a vibrant confluence of creativity, strategy, and innovation. Global Entrepreneurship Week is a worl

-dwide movement that celebrates and empowers innovators who bring ideas to life. Pitch Perfect embodied the spirit of GEW by equipping undergraduates with essential marketing skills to succeed in today's fast-paced business world. With a focus on crafting compelling brand stories, designing impactful marketing campaigns, and leveraging social media platforms like LinkedIn for personal and corporate branding, the workshop provided attendees with invaluable insights into the art and science of marketing.



GLOBAL
ENTREPRENEURSHIP
WEEK
SRI LANKA

Organized by



Powered by



Recruitment Partner



Mobility Partner



360° Marketing Partner



Entrepreneurship is
for Everyone
#GEW2024



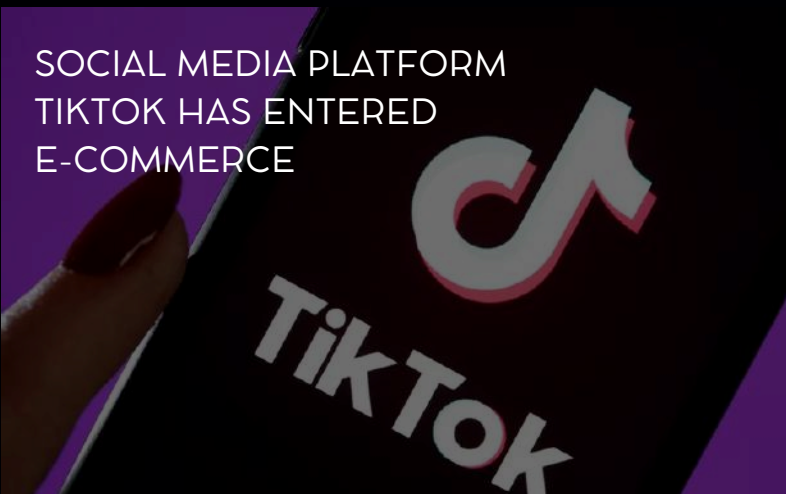
The session featured the renowned Amantha Perera—marketing strategist, digital creator, and stand-up comedian—who brought a unique mix of expertise and humor to the table alongside Shara Mackey, a Corporate Trainer and Educationist. Adding a layer of excitement, Pitch Perfect featured a special giveaway. One lucky participant walked away with a Carnage voucher, making the event all the more memorable.

Pitch Perfect was more than just a workshop—it was a celebration of entrepreneurship, creativity, and collaboration. By empowering undergraduates to embrace the dynamic world of marketing, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT reaffirmed its commitment to fostering a generation of innovative thinkers and doers.

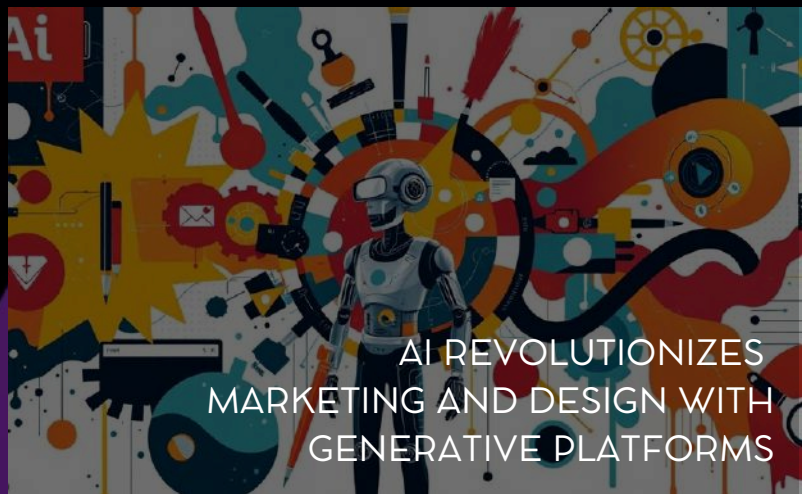


BUSINESS UPDATES: 2024'S BIGGEST STORIES

SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORM
TIKTOK HAS ENTERED
E-COMMERCE



AI REVOLUTIONIZES
MARKETING AND DESIGN WITH
GENERATIVE PLATFORMS



ECO-STARTUPS THRIVE AMID
DEMAND FOR SUSTAINABLE
INNOVATIONS



CREATOR ECONOMY
BOOMS AS INFLUENCERS BUILD
GLOBAL BRANDS



DIGITAL NOMAD VISAS
TRANSFORM WORK-LIFE
BALANCE WORLDWIDE



LUXURY FASHION JOINS
WEB3 WITH NFTS AND
BLOCKCHAIN PRODUCTS





INSIGHTS

WITH RENOWNED ENTREPRENEURS

FEAT A
VARIETY OF
DIFFERENT
ENTREPRENEURS

ADVISES FROM PROS

Learn what the pros have
to say to aspiring young
entrepreneurs

EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEWS

Get the latest scoop on these entrepreneurs
with our exclusive interviews featuring a
variety of insightful questions on starting off
as entrepreneurs and running startups.



Achala Samaradiwakara

THE GOOD MARKET

1) Can you tell us about the moment you decided to become an entrepreneur? What inspired you?

There wasn't a specific moment when I decided to become an entrepreneur. While working in the development sector, I noticed a gap, rural entrepreneurs lacked market access and opportunities to grow within a sustainable and inclusive economic system. This realization inspired me to co-found Good Market, aiming to address these challenges and create meaningful impact.

2) What was the biggest challenge you faced when starting your business, and how did you overcome it?

Starting a business comes with many challenges, both personal and structural. Initially, finding the right people to work alongside me was difficult, but I was fortunate to have a great co-founder who shared my vision. Financially, we faced significant constraints since we started Good Market with zero investment. To overcome this, we adopted creative, resource, efficient strategies to launch our platform without requiring significant capital. Consistency, commitment, and focused planning were key in building a solid foundation for our organization.

3) How do you stay motivated and focused during tough times?

Our purpose keeps us motivated. At Good Market, our mission is to create a responsible economic system that benefits both people and the planet. Seeing communities improve and having a network of conscious supporters around us fuels our drive to continue, even during challenging times.

4) What advice would you give to someone just starting out in entrepreneurship?

Start small but dream big. Focus on your purpose and take incremental steps toward your goals.

5) How do you approach innovation within your business? What drives your creativity?

Innovation at Good Market is driven by our purpose and the needs of the communities we work with. Creativity comes from listening to these needs, experimenting with ideas, and remaining open to collaboration. Our focus on ethical practices and sustainability shapes our innovative approaches to building value chains and fostering entrepreneurship.

6) What has been your most rewarding experience as an entrepreneur so far?

The most rewarding experience has been the tangible impact Good Market has created helping entrepreneurs grow, developing ethical value chains, and fostering a community of people committed to sustainable practices. Knowing that our work is making a difference keeps me inspired.

7) How do you manage work-life balance while running a business?

As a mother and a working professional, planning and prioritizing are crucial. It's about setting clear boundaries, focusing on what's most important, and ensuring I make time for both my family and work commitments.



8) What role has networking played in your entrepreneurial journey?

Networking has been essential. Building relationships with like-minded individuals, organizations, and communities has helped us grow Good Market and stay connected with people who share our values. Networking also provides support and insights, which are invaluable for entrepreneurship.



9) What are some of the key traits or skills that you believe every entrepreneur should have?

Entrepreneurs should have resilience, adaptability, a clear vision, and the ability to plan effectively. Creativity, collaboration, and strong communication skills are also vital for building relationships and solving problems.



10) Where do you see your business in the next five years, and what are your plans for growth?

In five years, we envision Good Market making a more significant impact both locally and globally. We plan to continue fostering sustainable economic systems by supporting ethical entrepreneurs and innovative value chains. Our focus will be on increasing transactions and collaborations to strengthen these systems further and create lasting change.



**GOOD
MARKET**
Sri Lanka



THE CATALYST

RONTAH MUKADANGE

1) Can you tell us about the moment you decided to become an entrepreneur? What inspired you?

I didn't have a single, defining moment when I decided to become an entrepreneur. It was more of a gradual realisation. My philosophy is to focus on the journey rather than the final destination. Every venture I've embarked on began with a personal problem that I sought to solve. Whether it was creating a few t-shirts for myself or building a brand and content team, problem-solving has always been my driving force. These challenges have been the primary source of my inspiration.

2) What was the biggest challenge you faced when starting your business, and how did you overcome it?

The biggest challenge I faced, like many others, was securing the initial capital. I wanted to bootstrap my business and avoid asking my parents for money, so I had to figure it out on my own. Before I turned 18, during the pandemic, I landed an internship as a digital marketing analyst at a consulting firm. I worked hard and eventually secured a full-time position, which gave me the financial resources to start my own business. This was just one of many challenges I encountered early on.

3) How do you stay motivated and focused during tough times?

I believe that motivation is fleeting, while discipline is enduring. It's unrealistic to expect to be constantly motivated. Everyone experiences ups and downs. True success lies in maintaining discipline and pushing through challenges. Entrepreneurship is inherently tough, and setbacks are inevitable. What sets successful entrepreneurs apart is their ability to adapt quickly and find solutions to problems. Adaptability is a crucial skill that helps you stay focused and recover from setbacks efficiently.

4) What has been your most rewarding experience as an entrepreneur so far?

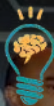
My most rewarding experience as an entrepreneur so far has been watching all the hard work pay off in truly surreal ways. For the Catalyst, seeing our first-ever drop sell out within just two weeks was incredibly validating—it felt like all our planning and passion connected perfectly with our audience. For Chroma Global, the highlight was the moment we signed the contract with our biggest client yet. It wasn't just about the growth; it was about the trust they placed in us to deliver their vision. Moments like these make all the challenges and late nights worthwhile, and they fuel our drive to keep pushing boundaries.

5) Where do you see your business in the next five years, and what are your plans for growth?

Within the next five years theCatalyst would be launching its first physical store and also globally selling its products and Chroma Global would be working with 2 very specific clients.

6) How has winning the "Creative Business Idea of the Year" at the New Gen Asia Awards impacted your business?

Winning the 'Creative Business Idea of the Year' at the New Gen Asia Awards was a real confidence boost for me and the team. It felt amazing to see that others believed in the ideas we've been so passionate about. More than anything, it reassured us that our creative approach has value, even if it sometimes feels a bit outside the box. It's given us the motivation to keep doing what we love and reminded us that staying true to our vision can really make an impact.



7) How do you manage work-life balance while running a business?

Honestly, work-life balance in the early stages of a business feels like a myth. I know not everyone may agree, but when you're just starting out, there's only so much balance you can achieve. It's not always a 50/50 split—sometimes it's more like 80/20, with work taking up the majority. In these stages, it's common to sacrifice sleep and personal time to push the limits and get things off the ground.

But I've learned that it's not just about the hours you put in; it's about the impact of the work you get done. Now, I focus on working as efficiently as possible, finding smart ways to accomplish tasks without always burning the midnight oil. It's about maximising productivity within those long hours, so that every effort counts.

8) How do you approach innovation within your business? What drives your creativity?

I believe that true innovation stems from understanding the needs of your customers. By putting myself in their shoes and actively listening to their feedback, I'm able to identify pain points and develop innovative solutions.

Listening to Clients and the Market: Understanding customer needs is crucial for developing innovative solutions.

Encouraging Team Collaborations: Fostering a collaborative environment allows for diverse perspectives and creative problem-solving. Staying Inspired and Informed: Maintaining a curious mindset and staying up-to-date with industry trends fuels creativity.

Curiosity is a major driver of my creativity, along with the satisfaction of seeing the impact of my work. Storytelling is one of my primary methods for sharing my creative ideas with the world.

chroma



Avi Suriyabandara

OWNER OF CACTUS MEDIA

1) Can you tell us about the moment you decided to become an entrepreneur? What inspired you?

I never was like, you know, I'm becoming an entrepreneur, but I never had that thought. Even though I am one now, I never thought about it. But what inspired me was the hard times that that that I had to go through as a child. I don't come from a rich background. We come from a very poor background. So I think that's what inspired me because I am a person who always wanted the fancy stuff, always wanted the nice lifestyle and all of that.

2) What was the biggest challenge you faced when starting your business, and how did you overcome it?

I think biggest challenge is finding good people, talented, loyal people. Because I've had a lot of employees and a lot of them have broken my heart. Yes, you know, business is business. I know where the fine line is, but you know, when they're not loyal to you and all, it does break my heart sometimes when I go above and beyond to treat them nicely. I would put that as my biggest challenge because everything else I know I can do it, however it is. So just finding good and loyal employees, I think that's one of the hardest things that I have faced.

3) How do you stay motivated and focused during tough times?

I think it's fear. I am, I mean, people might say that I'm not, I'm like, you know, I don't fear anything or whatever, but I think it's fear. I'm not always motivated, but I know that I have to do it. And then that's what keeps me up at night. That what's more, that's what motivates, motivates me to push and to be focused during tough times. It's the fact that, you know, I don't have plan A's and B's and C's. It's just I'm the only plan I got and I have to do it.

4) What advice would you give to someone just starting out in entrepreneurship?

My advice would be just start, whether you have money or whether you don't, don't, don't think that ah, this won't work, that won't work. I don't have this experience. Don't think about what you don't have. Think about what you have and just start. You'll fail. The more you fail, the more you learn and the more you know, chance of you being successful one day. So you just need one great idea and then that has to work properly. That's it. So never give up and then, you know, keep on pushing, keep on hustling. The main thing is always be humble.

5) How do you approach innovation within your business? What drives your creativity?

I think it's the fact that I want to satisfy myself. I'm a person who never gets satisfied by something. It's just like I imagined, I have a goal today and if I achieve it tomorrow, I'll be like, alright, cool, what's next? So I'm a person who is very hard to be satisfied. So I think that's what drives me, like let's say I create something really good, I do something really creative and I'm like, OK, cool, what's next? I want to do something more creative than that. So I think that's what my mentality is on how I approach innovation within the business and even when it comes to creativity. So I think that's what it is for me personally.

The logo for Cactus Media, featuring the word "cactus" in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font. The letter "c" is stylized to resemble a cactus plant with several small spines.

6) What has been your most rewarding experience as an entrepreneur so far?

I think the fact that I'm not in debt and that I can take care of my family is very rewarding. That's something that makes me happy. When I see my wife and when I see my dog happy, that's what rewards me. So if it is something personal, I'm not very happy at the moment. As I mentioned, I am not a person who can be satisfied very easily. So that's that. I want to push as much as possible

7) How do you manage work life balance while running a business?

I try to balance it, but I don't think I'm balancing it at the moment because I'm in my 20s and I have a plan of retiring very soon. So if you say currently my personal life is like 10% and my work life is 90%. Yes, my wife doesn't like it. I'm always working at night and even in the mornings. I think Sundays is the day that I keep that balance. But I try to keep a time for us to pray and keep a time for us to speak. So normally when my wife comes after work, we keep like an hour to talk with each other, to share each other's feelings and about how the day went and all. Also on Sundays after church, we go to our parents house, we meet our parents, say hi, what not. That's the only like family time I have.

Everything else is work at the moment. But later on, my career my plan is to keep more time for my family. The main thing is having discipline and being humble, I think that's all you need. That's the two key things I believe that every entrepreneur should have and they should never give up. So I think if you have these skills, you can overcome anything, pretty much anything in this life.





EXPLORING

THE LIVES OF OUR STUDENT
ENTREPRENEURS





Tips to Survive

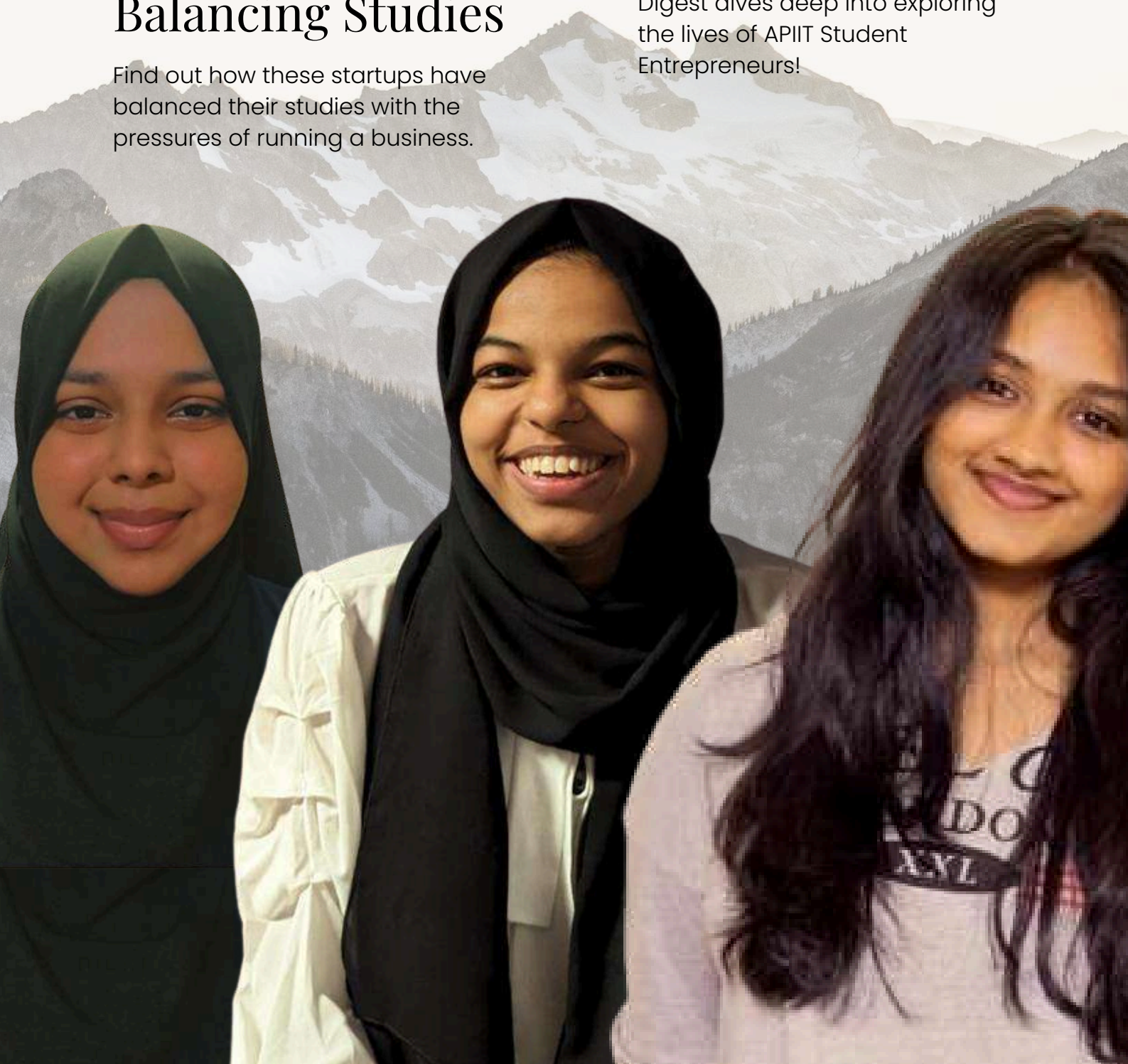
Get a range of advices from your own peers on how to survive those first few stages.

Balancing Studies

Find out how these startups have balanced their studies with the pressures of running a business.

Find out what our very own student entrepreneurs from APIIT have to say!

It is imperative to empower entrepreneurship within the youth and this segment of Innovator's Digest dives deep into exploring the lives of APIIT Student Entrepreneurs!





STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

SHERAYA SAMARANAYAKE

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Discover the beauty of customized press-on nails from Nail Express by Shery. Our passion is matching unique sets that fit your nails perfectly, ensuring a flawless and long-lasting manicure. Experience the convenience of press-ons without compromising on style or health. Our sets are designed to minimize damage and provide a quick, easy way to elevate your look

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

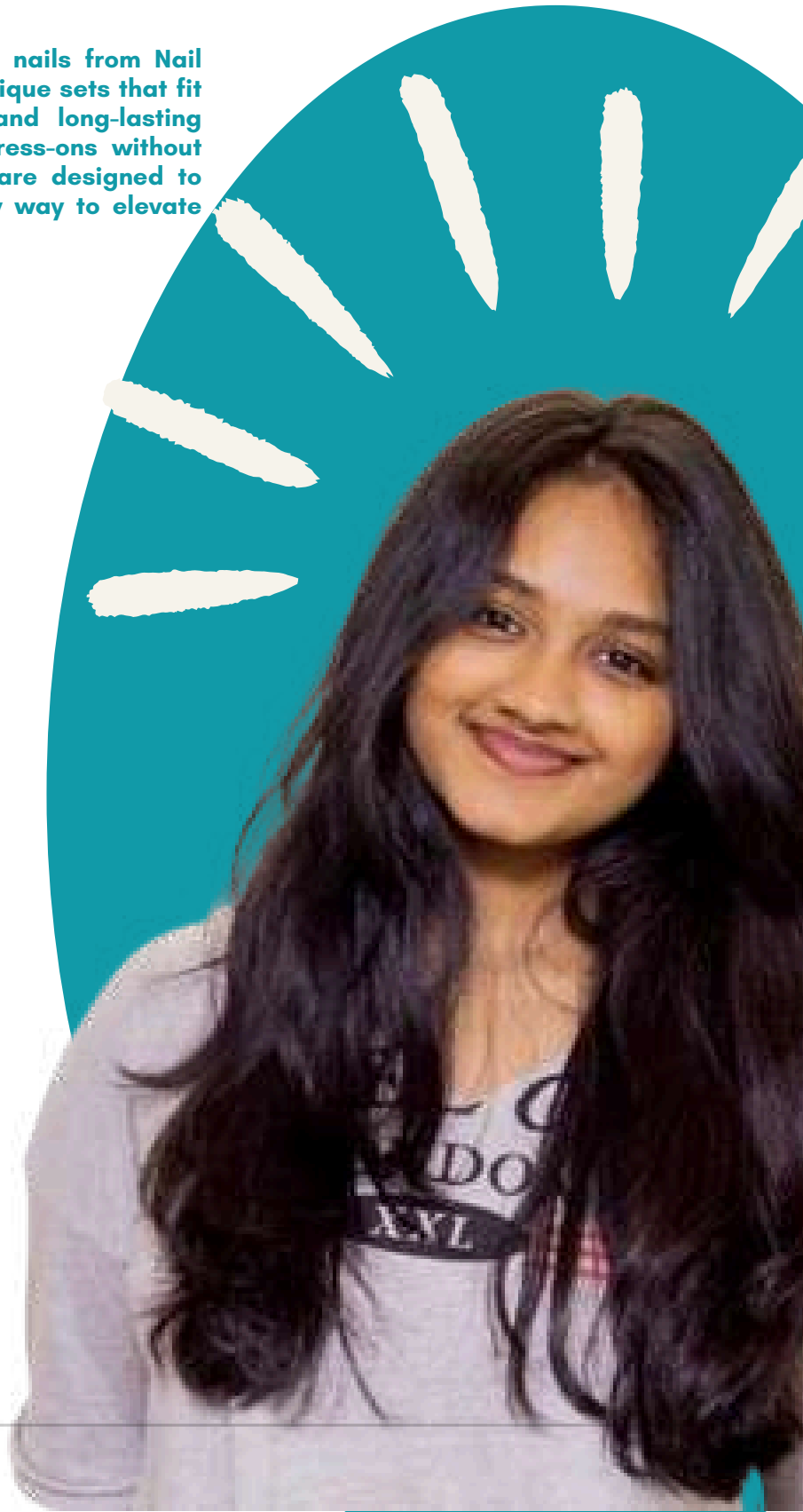
It was entirely a passion I had for getting my nails done. I'd always get my nails done frequently because I love doing it; however, I noticed that getting acrylic or gel nails done truly damaged my nail bed, which made me switch to press-ons that were quick and easy to use and barely left a mark! This sparked an idea in me: "Why not do what I love and make a business out of it?"

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

Balancing tutoring, assignments, and meeting customer orders. At the inception of my business, it was quite easygoing; my brand was known to only a few people, and I didn't have to meet too many customer orders; however, within the next month, I was selling out quickly, which led to many deliveries needing to be met as well.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

It's not entirely about the profit for me. It's about me enjoying what I do, and getting better at doing manicures on my customers! But doing my own venture gives me the peace of mind to be creative and explore my vision freely.



4. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Do you have any time management tips for other student entrepreneurs?

It's all about how you prioritize your daily routines, in my case, education has been the bigger priority for me pretty much all my life.. but it doesn't essentially restrict me from having time to do anything else; I don't have to force myself to manage my business activity, because I simply enjoy it!

My piece of advice is to do something you enjoy doing; that way, you won't have to "make time" for it, but rather you will naturally prioritize and dedicate time to it!

5. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

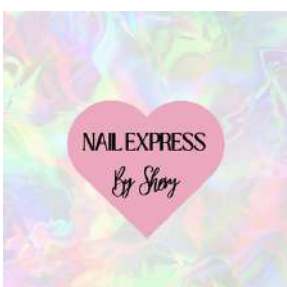
Social media, particularly Instagram and Canva.

6. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

Social media, particularly Instagram, has been instrumental for me in understanding and interpreting its algorithm. This has enabled my content to reach the precise audience I aim to target. Additionally, Canva has been invaluable in creating visually appealing videos and poster ads, capturing the attention of both my current clients and potential customers.

7. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope my business will empower individuals by enhancing their confidence and self-expression through quality nail services. I aim to set a standard of excellence in the beauty industry, inspiring others to pursue their passions fearlessly. Additionally, I aspire to create a positive and inclusive community where clients feel valued, respected, and beautiful.



@nailexpressbyshery

8. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey? What advice would you give to other students seeking mentorship?

I'd say my parents. They always saw potential in me and encouraged me to take risks. Regardless of whether my business would succeed or fail, they believed that the learnings gained along the way were what truly mattered in creating a beautiful outcome.

9. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

Pursue your passion, embrace failure as a learning opportunity, and build a strong support system to fuel motivation and make the entrepreneurial journey enjoyable. Surround yourself with mentors, peers, and advisors who offer guidance, support, and constructive feedback.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired?

My main source of motivation and inspiration comes from the positive impact I see on my clients. Their satisfaction and increased confidence remind me of why I started this business in the first place. Additionally, the continuous learning and growth opportunities in the beauty industry keep me inspired to innovate and improve.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

I wouldn't change anything. Everything I've built for my brand today is a result of how I started at its inception. The most enjoyable part of my entrepreneurial journey as a student has been the opportunity to combine my passion for beauty and creativity with business.

STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

ASIRA SUMANSEKERA

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Artifact Media is a creative agency that helps businesses stand out in today's crowded digital landscape. Their team of designers, writers, and marketers work together to craft compelling brand stories and campaigns that engage audiences and drive results.

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

My entrepreneurial spirit was sparked by a desire to go beyond the normal system, despite my parents' initial disapproval. From a young age, I engaged in small businesses and learned the importance of marketing. This led to founding Artifact Media, a creative agency to help businesses market their products and services.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

Some of the biggest challenges include losing projects after clients have finalized everything and dealing with cash flow management. These experiences taught me resilience and the importance of not giving up, as well as the critical need for careful financial planning and assembling the right team.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

Running my own venture allows me to bring my vision to life and break away from the conventional job security mindset. The freedom to innovate and the satisfaction of seeing my ideas come to life are highly motivating. Additionally, the continuous learning and personal growth opportunities are invaluable.



4. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Do you have any time management tips for other student entrepreneurs?

Balancing studies and running a business requires strict time management and prioritization. For fellow student entrepreneurs navigating this demanding journey, I recommend setting clear goals, delegating tasks whenever possible, and maintaining a disciplined schedule.

5. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

Entrepreneurship programmes and entrepreneurship books have been incredibly helpful. These resources provided valuable knowledge. Leveraging these opportunities has been crucial for my growth and development as an entrepreneur.

6. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

We market Artifact Media through a mix of social media, content marketing, and community engagement. Collaborations with university events and participation in local events have been particularly effective. Tailoring our strategies to our audience's preferences has driven successful campaigns.

7. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope Artifact Media will promote innovative marketing solutions and support other businesses in achieving their goals. In 5-10 years, I envision it expanding globally and becoming a leader in the creative agency industry. My goal is to create a lasting positive impact on the business world.



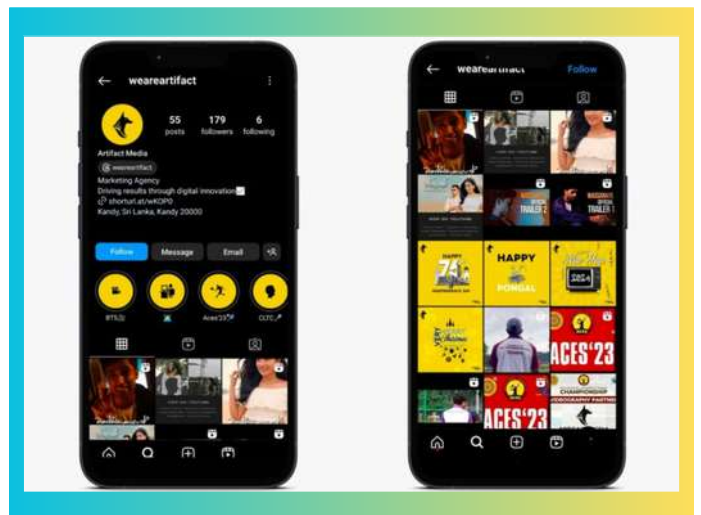
 @weareartifact

8. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey? What advice would you give to other students seeking mentorship?

Yes, I have several mentors who provided invaluable guidance and support. My advice to other students is to actively seek mentors who align with your goals and values. Building genuine relationships and being open to feedback are key to benefiting from mentorship.

9. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

My top three pieces of advice are: believe in your vision, be resilient, and continuously learn. The passion for my business and the desire to solve real-world problems keep me motivated. Celebrating small wins also helps me stay inspired along the journey.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired?

Looking back, I would focus more on building a strong network early on. The most enjoyable part of my entrepreneurial journey has been the freedom to innovate and the satisfaction of seeing my ideas come to life. The challenges have made the successes even more rewarding.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

I wouldn't change anything. Everything I've built for my brand today is a result of how I started at its inception. The most enjoyable part of my entrepreneurial journey as a student has been the opportunity to combine my passion for beauty and creativity with business.

STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

KAVINDU WANNISINGHE

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Black Canvas is a company built around the art of photography, turning passion into entrepreneurship. Specializing in event and wedding photography, Black Canvas is your go to for the highest quality photographic captures, owned by Kavindu Wannisinghe, the Vice President of the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT.

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

My passion for storytelling truly ignited in 2016 when I acquired my first camera. Experimenting with it, I discovered the magic of capturing stories through the lens. After years of experience and an unwavering love for the creative field, I felt compelled to take the leap and turn my passion into a venture. The idea for Black Canvas LK stemmed from wanting to use event photography as a platform to showcase narratives, emotions, and the unique essence of gatherings.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

One of the biggest hurdles has been balancing my studies with running Black Canvas LK. It requires meticulous time management and prioritizing tasks effectively. This journey has taught me the importance of staying organized, resilient, and adaptable. I've also learned to embrace the continuous learning curve that comes with being an entrepreneur.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

The freedom and creativity involved in running Black Canvas LK are incredibly fulfilling. I enjoy collaborating with clients and turning their visions into reality through my lens. Being my own boss allows me to steer the business in a direction that aligns with my values and creative vision.





4. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Do you have any time management tips for other student entrepreneurs?

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6. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

Building an online presence through social media platforms like Instagram and Facebook has been key. Engaging content, networking with event planners and vendors, and offering referral programs have proven effective in reaching my target audience.

7. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope Black Canvas LK goes beyond capturing events; I aspire to capture the essence of human connection and emotions that make every gathering unique. In 5-10 years, I envision Black Canvas LK expanding its services and becoming a leading photography company, capturing not just events but also personal stories and memories.



8. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey? What advice would you give to other students seeking mentorship?

I've been fortunate to connect with experienced photographers and entrepreneurs who have offered invaluable guidance and support. My advice to students seeking mentorship is to be proactive, network within your field, and approach individuals whose work and expertise resonate with you.

9. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

1. Passion is key:
Pursue an idea you're genuinely passionate about, as it will fuel your journey through challenges.
2. Embrace continuous learning:
Be open to learning new skills, adapting to evolving trends, and seeking knowledge from experienced individuals.
3. Build a strong network:
Connect with fellow student entrepreneurs, mentors, and individuals in your field for support and guidance.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired?

Witnessing the joy and appreciation on my clients' faces when they see their captured memories is incredibly rewarding. The creative freedom and opportunity to turn my passion into a profession are constant sources of motivation.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

While the journey has been challenging, I wouldn't change a thing. The experiences, lessons learned, and connections formed have been invaluable. The most enriching aspect has been witnessing the positive impact my work has on clients and the creative freedom to express myself through the lens.

STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

FATHIMA SALIHA

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Littlemissbakery is your go-to destination for delightful homemade cakes, brownies, and cookies. With a deep passion for baking and an unwavering commitment to quality, we craft sweet treats that bring joy to every occasion. At **LittleMissBakery**, we're here to make your days a little sweeter!

Little Miss Bakery.
COOKIES, CAKES, AND SWEET TREATS
| EST. 2023 |

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

I always had an interest in baking since it was therapeutic for me. However, my early attempts often ended in epic failures, and even now, I still face occasional mishaps. To improve, I took a course and got better at it. This improvement and my passion for baking eventually sparked the idea of turning it into a business.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

The biggest challenges have been managing time between baking and other commitments, dealing with the occasional baking failures, and learning how to market my products effectively. From these experiences, I've learned the importance of persistence, continuous learning, and adapting to feedback.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

Because I'm my own boss, I enjoy the autonomy and the ability to make my own decisions. It gives me a sense of control and fulfillment that I wouldn't get working for someone else.





4. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

Courses on baking, online marketing resources, and networking with other entrepreneurs have been incredibly helpful. My cousin, who also owns a business, has been a valuable resource as we share our experiences and learn from each other.

5. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Do you have any time management tips for other student entrepreneurs?

Balancing studies and running a business requires strict time management and prioritization. I make use of planners and to-do lists to keep track of tasks and deadlines. My tip for other student entrepreneurs is to set clear boundaries between study time and business time, and to not hesitate to ask for help when needed.

6. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

I use social media platforms to showcase my baked goods and engage with my audience. Word of mouth has also been very effective. Hosting small events and offering samples has helped attract more customers.

7. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope my business can bring joy to people through delicious baked goods and inspire others to pursue their passions. In 5-10 years, I see my business expanding with a physical storefront and a larger customer base.

8. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey?

Yes, my cousin, who also owns a business, has been a great mentor. We share our experiences and help each other improve.

9. What advice would you give to other students seeking mentorship?

Seek out mentors who have experience in your field and are willing to share their knowledge. Don't be afraid to reach out and ask for guidance, as most people are pleased to help if they can.



10. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs? What keeps you motivated and inspired?

- 1 - Stay persistent: There will be challenges, but don't give up.
 - 2 - Keep learning: Take courses, read books, and seek feedback to improve continuously.
 - 3 - Network: Connect with other entrepreneurs and learn from their experiences.
- My passion for baking and the positive feedback from customers keep me motivated and inspired.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

I don't think I would have done anything differently, except perhaps taking a few more piping courses for my cakes. The journey itself has been enjoyable because baking is my therapy and seeing people enjoy my creations brings me immense joy.

STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

AMRA ASKAR

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Asteria is an affordable jewelry brand celebrated for its unique designs. If you're seeking high-quality jewelry without breaking the bank, Asteria is the perfect choice. The brand offers a range of beautifully crafted pieces, ensuring that you can find something special that suits your style.

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

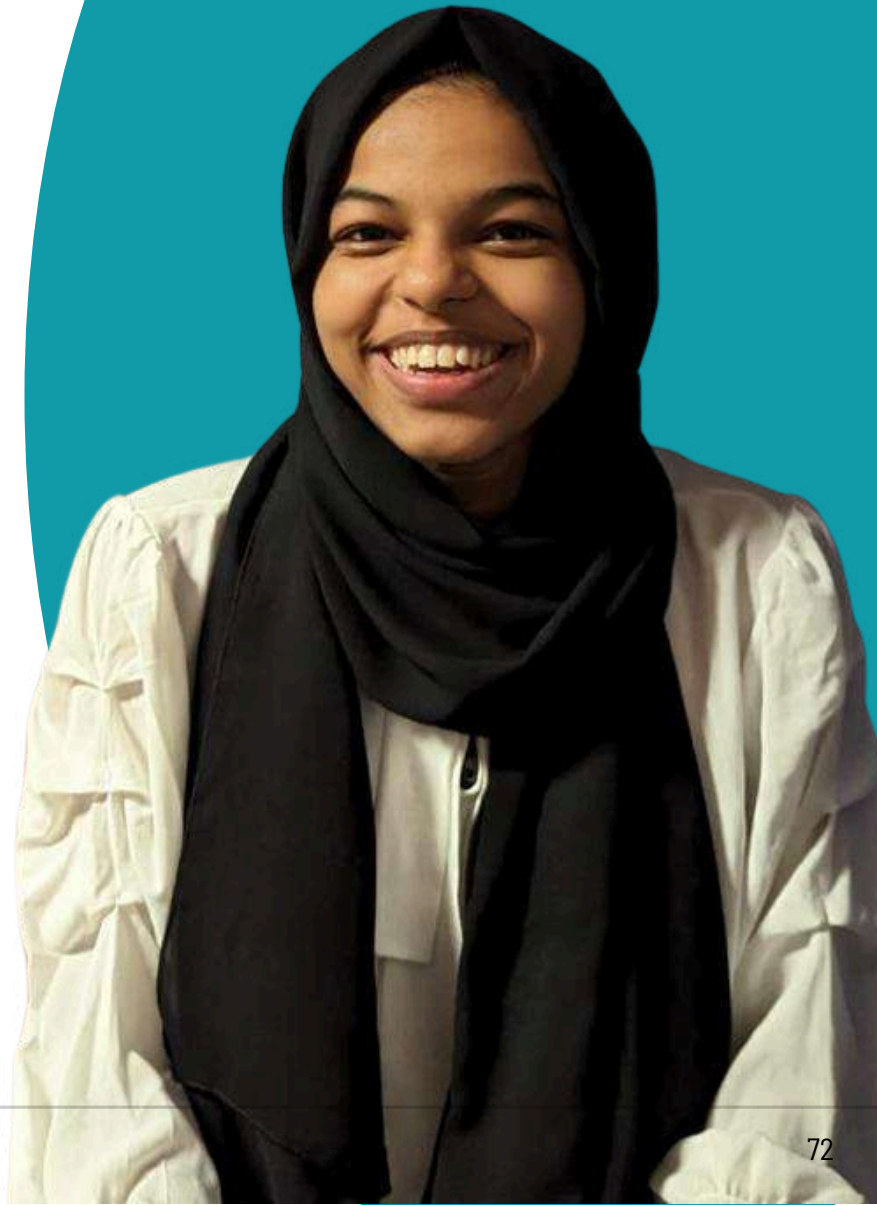
My entrepreneurial spirit was sparked by a passion for creativity. I came up with the idea for my jewelry business- Asteria as a way to generate the necessary capital to fund my future café. Asteria provides a solid foundation and financial support allowing me to refine my entrepreneurial skills, understand market dynamics, and build a loyal customer base to achieve my long-term goal.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

The biggest challenges I've faced so far in my jewelry business have been financial constraints and building a loyal customer base. Starting with limited capital made it difficult to invest in high-quality materials and marketing efforts, which are essential for growing a business. Additionally, in a competitive market, establishing a loyal customer base has been a challenge.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

It allows me the freedom to pursue my passions and bring my creative visions to life. Being my own boss gives me the flexibility to make decisions that align with my values and goals. It allows me to innovate, experiment, and adapt. Moreover, this venture is a stepping stone towards my long-term goal of opening a café.





4. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

As a student entrepreneur, social media and Meta Business Suite have been incredibly valuable resources. Meta Business Suite, in particular, has been a game-changer by enabling me to plan and schedule posts in advance. This feature helps me manage my time more efficiently.

5. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

I market my jewelry business primarily through social media and events like pop-ups. Social media platforms have been instrumental in reaching my target audience by showcasing my designs, engaging with potential customers, and running targeted ads. This helps build brand awareness and drive traffic to my business. Additionally, participating in pop-up events allows me to connect with customers in person, provide a tangible experience of my products, and gather direct feedback. These strategies have been effective in building a loyal customer base and increasing visibility for my jewelry business.

6. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope my jewelry business will make a meaningful impact by offering unique, high-quality pieces that bring joy to my customers and reflect my passion for creativity. In 5-10 years, I envision my business thriving and well-established, with a strong reputation and a loyal customer base. I aim to expand my product line and possibly open a physical store that reflects the essence of my brand. Additionally, my long-term goal is to use the capital and experience gained from my jewelry business to open a café, where customers can enjoy a warm, inviting atmosphere complemented by my jewelry designs.

8. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

My top piece of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs is: First, embrace failure as a learning opportunity. Second, stay adaptable in a rapidly changing world. And third, always prioritize customer satisfaction—it's the key to sustainable growth. What keeps me motivated? Seeing my vision slowly take shape and knowing that every setback is a stepping stone to success.

9. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey?

Yes, I've been fortunate to have the support of my friends, family, and, most importantly, my best friend, who has been a tremendous source of encouragement and advice throughout my journey. For other students seeking mentorship, I would advise reaching out to individuals who genuinely care about your success and have experience in your field of interest.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired? What keeps you motivated and inspired?

My top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs are: don't lose hope, trust the process, and keep working towards your end goal. Stay focused on your long-term objectives and embrace the journey, even when faced with setbacks. What keeps me motivated and inspired is the progress I see from my hard work and the support from my friends, family, and best friend.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

Looking back, I wouldn't change a thing. I'm proud of starting my entrepreneurial journey early and using my own capital to fund it. This experience has been incredibly rewarding, teaching me valuable lessons and allowing me to grow both personally and professionally. What I've enjoyed most about this journey is the sense of accomplishment that comes from seeing my ideas come to life.

STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

AMANYA EKANAYAKA

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Tea-Licious is a unique and refreshing beverage experience. Each tea is carefully brewed and infused with natural ingredients to offer a burst of flavor in every sip. Whether you're looking to cool down on a hot day or simply enjoy a delicious drink, my iced teas are the perfect choice

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

My entrepreneurial spirit was sparked during my time as a Barista at Food Studio Colombo City Center. I loved the hustle of the food industry and always had this vision of starting my food chain someday. During the COVID lockdown, I seized the opportunity to deepen my knowledge with online courses in entrepreneurship and marketing, which fueled my ambition.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

The biggest challenge so far has been dealing with the initial drop in orders when I first launched. It was a tough moment that tested my confidence and decision-making. But from that experience, I learned resilience and the importance of persistence in pursuing your dreams, even when things don't go as planned.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

Running my venture gives me a sense of control and the freedom to innovate. Sure, there are ups and downs—every business has them. The initial drop in orders scared me, but it also taught me valuable lessons about market dynamics and customer engagement.



4. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

The most helpful resources for me have been online courses, especially during the lockdown, which provided me with essential knowledge in digital marketing and entrepreneurship. Additionally, networking with fellow entrepreneurs and mentors through online communities has been invaluable for advice and support.

5. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

Marketing my business has been a blend of social media engagement on Instagram and TikTok, targeted online ads, and collaborations with influencers who resonate with my brand. These strategies have helped me reach my target audience effectively.

6. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

Ultimately, I hope my business can make a positive impact by offering quality products and creating memorable experiences for customers. In 5-10 years, I envision expanding into a food chain known for its unique offerings and excellent customer service.

7. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Any tips for others?

Balancing studies with running a business is all about effective time management. I've learned to prioritize tasks and allocate specific times for studying and business operations. My tip for fellow student entrepreneurs would be to create a schedule and stick to it, but also be flexible enough to adapt when unexpected challenges arise.

8. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

My top piece of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs is: First, embrace failure as a learning opportunity. Second, stay adaptable in a rapidly changing world. And third, always prioritize customer satisfaction—it's the key to sustainable growth. What keeps me motivated? Seeing my vision slowly take shape and knowing that every setback is a stepping stone to success.

9. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey?

While I haven't had formal mentors or advisors, I've relied on my own research, networking, and learning from industry trends. It's been a journey of self-discovery and self-reliance, which has its challenges but also its rewards in personal growth.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired? What keeps you motivated and inspired?

My top piece of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs is: First, embrace failure as a learning opportunity. Second, stay adaptable in a rapidly changing world. And third, always prioritise customer satisfaction—it's the key to sustainable growth. What keeps me motivated? Seeing my vision slowly take shape and knowing that every setback is a stepping stone to success.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

Looking back, I wouldn't change a thing about starting my entrepreneurial journey as a student. The challenges have been tough, but they've also been incredibly rewarding in terms of personal and professional growth. The most enjoyable part has been seeing my ideas come to life and making a tangible impact through my business.





student articles





IMPORTANCE OF LAW IN THE BUSINESS WORLD



Business Law determines the formal process of establishment of a business organization and regulations related to selling of corporate entities. It plays a vital role in the functioning of modern economies and the success of businesses.

Moreover, the legal framework for a business's formation, operation and dissolution is provided by business law. It defines various types of business entities, each with its own rights and obligations, such as sole proprietorships, partnerships, corporations, and limited liability companies. Additionally, contracts are the foundation of most business transactions, contracts which are necessary for doing business, are created, interpreted, and enforced under the rules of business law. It offers a set of guidelines to make sure the contracts are clear, legally binding, and equitable. Furthermore, the rights and interests of businesses, their owners, employees, and clients are protected by business law.

BY MADHUMITHA BALAJEYANDHAN

In addition, Business Law is also a subset of intellectual property laws, which cover things like patents, trademarks, and copyrights. They protect a company's innovations and intellectual property, which are frequently priceless assets. Business law also protects the consumers from unfair business practices such as false advertising, product liability, and antitrust violations. Moreover, by giving startups and innovations a legal framework, business law supports entrepreneurship. Through a variety of legal tools, it enables business owners to secure funding and project their inventions and ideas.

Additionally, a solid legal framework helps to maintain economic stability by providing consistency and security for business operations, this stability is essential to draw capital and promote economic expansion. In conclusion, business law forms the basis for the efficient and moral operation of businesses. It offers the guidelines required to uphold the interests and rights of people, businesses, and society at large while also fostering stability and economic growth.





THE IMPORTANCE OF ENTREPRENEURS

BY MOHAMMED AZWER FATHIMA SHAHEENA



Embarking on the journey of entrepreneurship requires more than just a business idea; it demands a unique mindset, unwavering determination, and a willingness to navigate through challenges. In this article, we delve into the essence of entrepreneurship, examining the opportunities it presents, the hurdles entrepreneurs often face, and the profound impact they have on society. From defining the traits of successful entrepreneurs to showcasing the latest innovations in the field, this exploration aims to inspire aspiring business leaders and shed light on the dynamic landscape of entrepreneurship.

An entrepreneur is like a magician of ideas, turning dreams into reality with a sprinkle of hard work and resilience. Their characteristics include creativity, adaptability, and a healthy appetite for risk-taking.



Having a growth mindset is like fuel for entrepreneurs, It's the belief that ability can be developed through dedication and hard work. In the entrepreneurial world, embracing challenges, learning from failures, and seeking feedback are key to success.

Entrepreneurs are like detectives, they always look for gaps in the market that they can fill with innovative solutions. By keenly observing consumer needs and trends, they can create products or services that make a real impact.

There are many challenges faced by entrepreneurs, some of them are financial constraints and funding, risk management, and decision making. Money matters can make or break an entrepreneur's dreams. Navigating through financial constraints and securing funding can be a rollercoast-



-er ride, but it's all part of the entrepreneurial journey towards building a sustainable business. Entrepreneurs are like chess players, constantly strategizing and making calculated moves. Managing risks, making tough decisions, and staying agile in the face of uncertainty are all part and parcel of the entrepreneurial hustle. There are many impacts of entrepreneurship, some of them are Job Creation, Economic Growth, Social Innovation and community development. Entrepreneurs are the unsung heroes of job creation, driving economic growth and prosperity. By starting businesses, they not only create employment opportunities but also stimulate innovation and contribute to the overall economic landscape.



Entrepreneurship isn't just about profits, it's about creating a positive impact on society. Socially conscious entrepreneurs focus on addressing pressing social issues, promoting sustainability, and championing community development, leaving a legacy beyond mere business success. Some of the key traits of successful entrepreneurs are resilience and adaptability, vision and creativity, resources and support for entrepreneurs, networking and mentorship, and access to incubators and accelerators.

There are some Innovations and Trends in Entrepreneurship, they are E-commerce, Digital Marketing, and Sustainability and Social Entrepreneurship. In today's digital age, E-commerce is the new frontier for entrepreneurs. From selling handmade crafts on Etsy to running a global empire on Amazon, the possibilities are limitless. Digital marketing is the secret sauce that helps entrepreneurs reach their target audience, build brand awareness, and drive sales in the online realm. It's like having a virtual megaphone to shout your business from the rooftops.

Gone are the days of business as usual. Entrepreneurs today are not just in it for the profits but also for the planet and the people. Sustainability and social entrepreneurship are the buzzwords of the hour, with social impact initiatives becoming key drivers of success. It's not just about making money; it's about making a difference in the world.



SMALL BUSINESS AND IT'S ECONOMIC IMPORTANCE

BY JANANI CHAYA WALISINGHA



Economic development is largely based on small enterprises. Especially in less urbanized areas, they are the largest employers. For the production generated by a single region, small businesses are responsible. Growing entrepreneurial skills foster innovation.

Today, this is the basis for the socio-economic development of EU countries. The increase in the opening of small enterprises contributes positively to the economic development measured by the per capita value of total production generated by local entrepreneurs, as well as the number of employees. Small businesses contribute positively to the economic development of the country. The GDP positively impacts the country's economic development. The rapid growth of small-scale businesses started in the 1970s and continues to this day. Small businesses are characterized by flexibility, agility, and the ability to quickly respond to market requirements.



The importance of small businesses is evidenced by their high presence in the economic structure of the country. Ultimately, small business performance is recovering from the COVID-19 pandemic faster than anticipated but has yet to reflect normal growth rates. The survival rate of small businesses is two-thirds. Small business is among the most powerful symbols of modern capitalism. The real boom in small business political consciousness came in the early 20th century. Small businesses, in other words, achieved their value through their innovative contributions rather than servicing or maintaining an existing system.



According to the latest SBA figures, small businesses employ nearly half of all private sector workers, which is represented by 46.4%. In addition, small businesses are often seen as nimbler than their larger counterparts, making them a major source of new innovations. In addition, studies have shown that small business owners are more satisfied with their jobs than others. Small businesses transform and develop communities. New small businesses are critical for economic growth and innovative capacity. The main interests of new small businesses are critical for economic growth and innovative capacity. Poverty reduction and economic growth are the main political interests in entrepreneurship.

The annual report of European Union small businesses confirmed that small businesses remain the European Union's economic backbone despite the global financial crisis. 66% of small businesses contribute to employment in the European Union. Attention to small businesses has been heightened because of the globalizing economy and the increasing severe competition that is inherent in the development.

SMEs are largely run by women. This facilitates the development of SME's, which allows society to capitalize on the skills of educated and trained women who may be blocked in corporate advancement because of the 'glass ceiling'. The increased flexibility inherent in owning one's own business allows women to contribute to the income of their families while balancing their work and family responsibilities, thus enhancing social cohesion. Small businesses face regulatory challenges. These regulations include tax, licencing and permits. Failing to comply with these regulations can result in costly fines and legal fees, which can be detrimental to small businesses. By creating a favourable environment for startups, governments can promote economic growth.

Entrepreneurship is the process that leads to the creation of SMEs while they fund their businesses by taking small business loans. Small businesses contribute significantly to GDP and employment rates. These enterprises encompass a wide range of industries, from local firms. Regardless of the sector, small businesses share a common trait: the entrepreneurial spirit that drives them to solve problems and meet the needs of their communities. Finally, small businesses are playing a vital role in the overall development of the economy because they produce a lot of employment opportunities for the young generation. This concept plays a vital role in fulfilling the demands of business and the daily demands of individuals.



PSYCHOLOGY OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP



80% of success is accessed by your psychology, 20% is in your actions.



The psychology of Entrepreneurship relates to understanding the relationship between successful business leadership and the mental strategies and traits that thriving entrepreneurs have. Fortunately, the likelihood of developing a successful business may increase if the individual running it recognizes the significance of specific psychological attributes. An essential factor for future entrepreneurs to take into account is their understanding of human behaviour and how it relates to business.



Moreover, there is a similarity in the ways that entrepreneurs approach their business, despite the fact that each individual has a unique mind. For instance, entrepreneurs are often driven to address a particular issue or close a particular market gap. Additionally, entrepreneurs tend to be confident and independent, and they are not afraid to take calculated risks to place a wager on themselves.



Furthermore, what comes to our mind when we think about achieving success as an entrepreneur? When making decisions to enter the business world, we consider several elements, including finances, leadership, critical thinking, and market trends. But psychology is rarely taken into account as a contributing component and some people might be surprised to learn that psychology can be a key factor in assisting people in becoming a profitable entrepreneur.

In addition, knowing psychology is vital in entrepreneurship as our emotions influence our decisions when it comes to business. This is the reason why startups and multinational corporations invest a significant amount of money in developing interesting digital marketing campaigns as it is critical to comprehend customer psychology in order to handle services and products effectively. Successful entrepreneurs typically possess a thorough understanding of customer psychology.

Additionally, innovative and creative thinking are frequently found in successful entrepreneurs. They are skilled at coming up with creative ways to solve issues because they view challenges as opportunities. Moreover, a strong sense of passion for what they do motivates many business owners. Their motivation stems from the desire to pursue their interests, create something significant, or have a beneficial influence in the field they have chosen.

Furthermore, successful entrepreneurs typically have a very clear business vision and are very goal-oriented. They have high standards for themselves and strive hard to meet them, but they're also adaptable enough to change course when necessary. Furthermore, establishing a business can be difficult, and failures are unavoidable. Entrepreneurs must possess resilience and persistence in order to overcome setbacks and failures with determination and hope. In conclusion, the psychology of entrepreneurship is a complex network of characteristics, actions and, desires that inspire people to take on the demanding yet rewarding task of starting and managing their own businesses. Entrepreneurs have a special mix of psychological traits that make them stand out, from a willingness to take calculated risks and a flair for creativity to determination in the face of adversity and a deep-seated passion for their profession.



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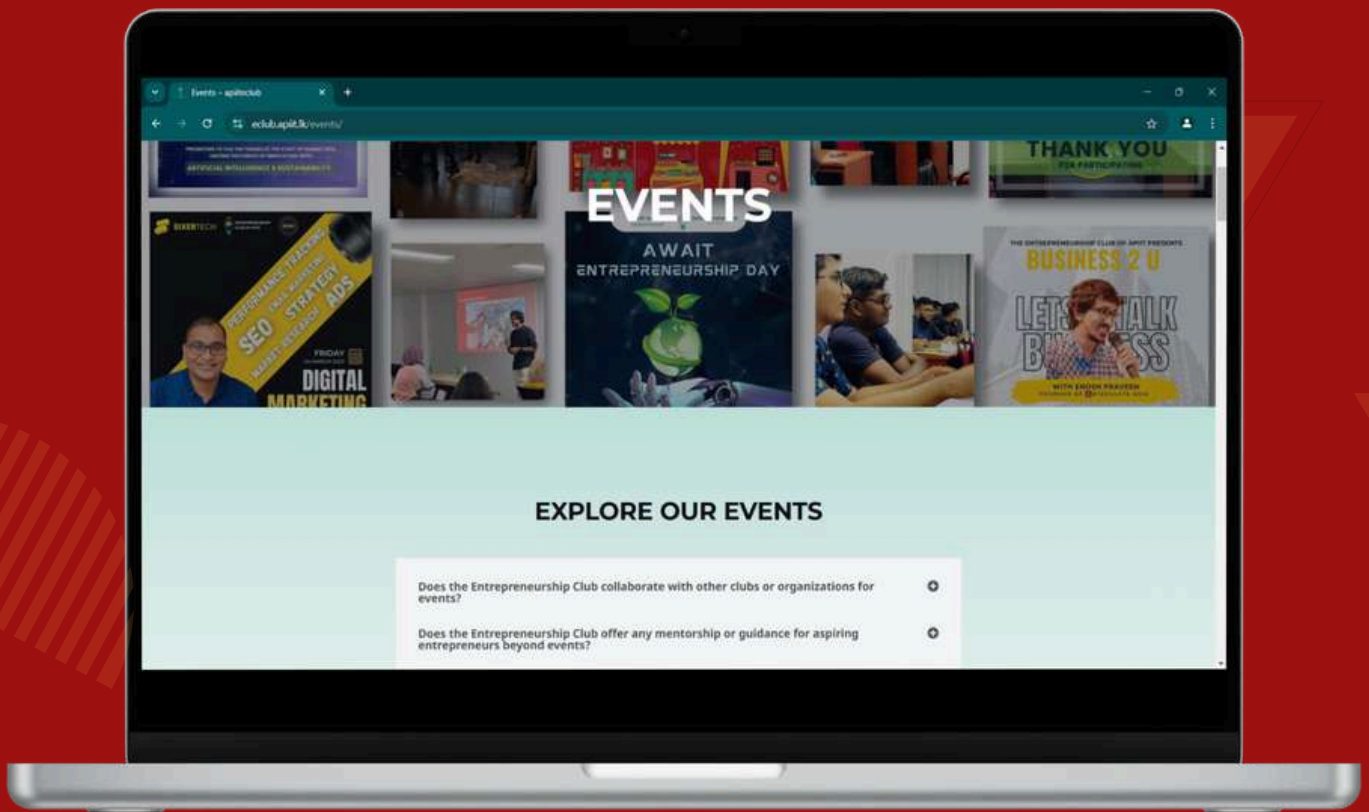
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